

"YOU AND ONLY YOU"

EXT. ANIMAL & REPTILE PRESERVE/ALLIGATOR LAKE - DAY

Zara watches HANDLERS feed alligators. Impressed by their ferocity she mimics the alligators by snapping her mouth, appearing almost insane.

INT. ANIMAL & REPTILE PRESERVE/SNAKE ROOM - DAY

Zara, mesmerized, watches a SNAKE inside a large, glass cage.

RANDY

Doctor Alston? We found what caused
the laceration.

Zara snaps out of it and turns to him. Expecting to hear her ask what it was, he waits. However, Zara continues to look at him. Randy becomes uncomfortable.

RANDY (CONT'D)

It was a broken beer bottle.

She returns her attention to the snake. He follows her gaze.

ZARA

A shame we don't know who it was.

When he doesn't respond, she looks at him until he realizes she expects him to. He stumbles trying to answer quickly.

RANDY

Why ahhh...why is that, Doctor Alston?

JUNGLE BEAT BEGINS softly, gradually getting louder.

ZARA

Perhaps we could sic this charming
fellow after the culprit.

She looks at the snake, mesmerized by it. Unseen by them, Blake, in a business suit, watches from the shadows.

ZARA (CONT'D)

Classified Dendroaspis polylepis, it
belongs to the family Elapidae. But
commonly known as...the Black Mamba.

RANDY

Exactly how poisonous is it?

ZARA

Stick your hand inside and find out.

Randy inadvertently takes a wary step back.

ZARA (CONT'D)

Exactly. This twelve-foot beauty is death incarnate and one of the swiftest you'll ever encounter.

RANDY

How fast? Could it catch a human?

JUNGLE BEAT INTENSIFIES as Randy moves his face close to the glass where the BLACK MAMBA seems to size him up.

ZARA

In an open, flat area, no. Not an adult. But in tall grass, bushes...
(smiles to herself)
...or say an enclosed area like in someone's home...that's another story.

RANDY

Why doesn't it look black?

ZARA

It's named for the inside color of it's mouth which is purple-black, and when angered, will gladly show you during its threat-display.

She pounds the glass. The snake lifts its head, mouth agape inches from the glass. Randy jumps back. Zara doesn't flinch. JUNGLE BEAT ENDS WITH A BANG. Dumfounded, the shaken attendant exits posthaste. Zara continues staring at the black mamba.

BLAKE (O.S.)

Did you enjoy that?

Turning, Zara comes back from wherever her mind has been and gives Blake the once-over.

ZARA

Now where might you be going cutting such a fine figure?

BLAKE

To an allocation meeting.

ZARA

They finally agreed on a new budget?

BLAKE

They did, and I have every intention of getting as much of it as I can.

ZARA

Since the board is nearly all women, I don't foresee any problem for you. Women love handsome men.

BLAKE

A lot of good that's done me. What's it been? Several weeks?

ZARA

It's not like you don't have other women in that black book of yours.

BLAKE

None quite like you, however.

ZARA

True, but I haven't been in the mood.

BLAKE

You not in the mood isn't normal. Forget him. No matter what you do, and you've done enough, it's over.

ZARA

Why are you here?

BLAKE

You haven't returned any of my calls.

ZARA

I've been busy.

She stares at the snake. He follows her stare with his eyes.

BLAKE

That's what I was afraid of.

EXT. RADIO STATION/PARKING LOT - NIGHT

From a distance we see John, Stacy and Gary exit. John and Gary high-five. As Gary walks to his car, Stacy hugs John.

INT. ZARA'S RANGE ROVER - IMMEDIATE

Zara jealously watches Stacy wave and walk away from John toward her car while John heads for his Corvette.

ZARA

Why you saucy little bitch!